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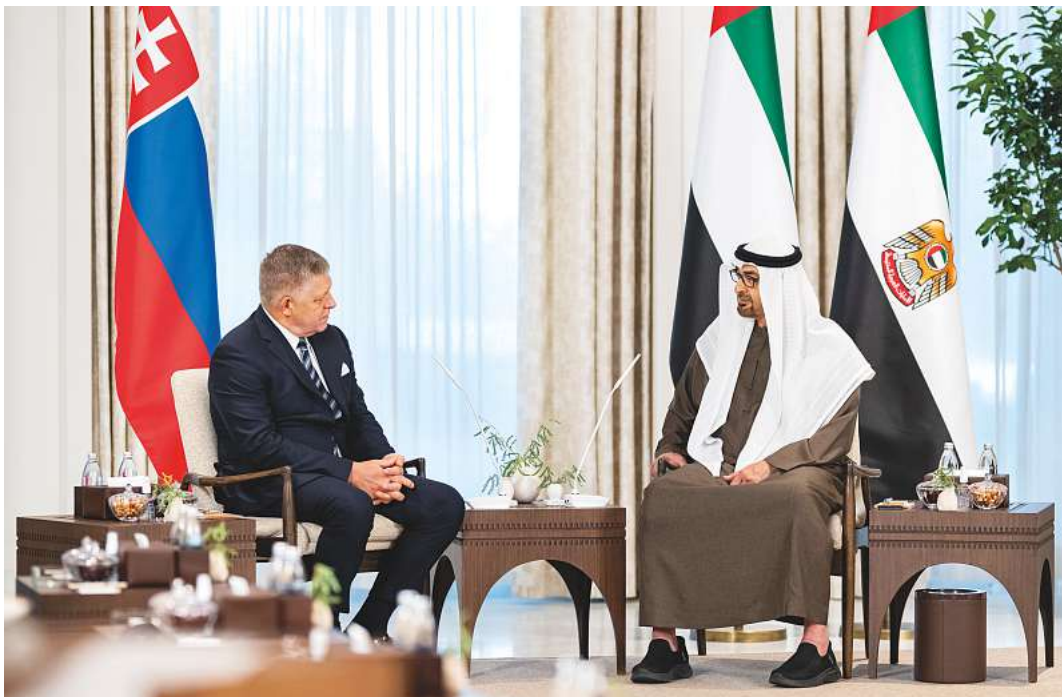
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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, SLOVAKIAN PRIME MINISTER DISCUSS BILATERAL TIES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Robert Fico, Prime Minister of Slovakia, held talks yesterday at Qasr Al Shati to explore ways to strengthen bilateral cooperation and expand prospects for development, particularly in areas such as the economy, trade, renewable energy, innovation, future technologies, and culture.

Dubai best city to live in the Gulf

Gulf capitals climb
Kearney's 2025
Global Cities Index

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Gulf cities are surging in global rankings for livability, innovation and infrastructure investment, according to Kearney's 2025 Global Cities Report. Dubai led the region, placing 23rd globally and maintaining its position as the Mena leader, while Abu Dhabi, Riyadh and Manama recorded some of the strongest year-on-year gains worldwide. The Global Cities Index (GCI)

assesses 158 cities on business activity, human capital, information exchange, cultural experience and political engagement. While New York, London, Paris, Tokyo and Singapore retained the top five positions, Gulf cities rose sharply as transformation strategies accelerated investment in digital infrastructure and quality of life.

Adaptability, not legacy

Rudolph Lohmeyer, Senior Partner at Kearney's Global Business Policy Council and Head of the National Transformations Institute, said the shift reflects how cities are being redefined by adaptability, not legacy. "Cities are no longer defined by legacy advantages or

sheer scale. Their competitiveness now rests on how well they can cultivate talent, build trust in digital systems, and design liveable environments that can withstand volatility. The Gulf's trajectory is a clear example of how aligning these factors can change a city's global standing in just a few years," he said.

In the Gulf, Riyadh advanced eight places to 56th, supported by economic diversification and global connectivity. Manama climbed ten places to 125th, reflecting Bahrain's growing regional competitiveness, while Abu Dhabi and Dammam saw among the highest improvements in human-capital metrics, supported by education and immigration reforms.

Trump assures Gaza ceasefire still in force

ISRAEL'S KEREM SHALOM BORDER
CROSSING REOPENS FOR AID

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump said Sunday that a ceasefire in Gaza was still holding after Israel carried out deadly strikes on the territory over alleged truce violations by Hamas.

The strikes Israel carried out on Hamas positions in southern Gaza Sunday came after it accused the militant group of targeting its troops in "a blatant violation" of the nine-day-old truce. Asked by reporters whether the truce was still in effect, Trump said: "Yeah, it is". The US President, who helped broker the deal, also suggested that Hamas leadership was not involved in any alleged breaches, instead blaming "some rebels within".

"We want to make sure that it's going to be very peaceful with Hamas," Trump said. "It's going to be handled toughly, but properly."

Aid flows into Gaza

Meanwhile, Israel's Kerem Shalom border crossing into Gaza reopened for aid yesterday, an Israeli military official said, a day after Israel closed it, accusing Hamas of violating the on-going ceasefire.

Following a decision at the political level, aid flowed through Kerem Shalom "in full compliance with the signed agreement," the official said,



We want to make sure that it's going to be very peaceful with Hamas. It's going to be handled toughly, but properly."

Donald Trump
US President

adding that Gaza's Rafah crossing to Egypt "will remain closed until further notice."

Gaza's civil defence agency, which operates under Hamas authority, said the strikes on Sunday killed at least 45 people across the territory. Four hospitals in Gaza confirmed the death toll of 45 to AFP, saying they had received the dead and wounded.

Israel's military said it was looking into the reports of casualties.

Israel said on Sunday that two of its soldiers died in clashes in the city of Rafah.

The army said it had "renewed enforcement of the ceasefire" on Sunday but vowed to "respond firmly to any violation of it".

Hamas denied the accusations, one official accusing Israel of fabricating "pretexts" to resume the war.

The ceasefire, which began on October 10, halted more than two years of devastating war between Israel and Hamas. — AFP

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